

3.1.3 Setting business aims and objectives

Content	Additional information
• What are business aims and objectives • Purpose of setting objectives • Role of objectives in running a business • Changing objectives • Use of objectives in judging success	Students should be able to: • understand the main aims and objectives for businesses: survival, profit maximisation, growth (domestic and international), market share, customer satisfaction, social and ethical objectives and shareholder value • understand the role of objectives in running a business • understand how and why the objectives set will differ between businesses (reasons include the size of the business, level of competition faced and type of business (not-for-profit organisations)) • understand how and why the objectives set may change as businesses evolve. Students should consider how the objectives of larger more established businesses might differ from smaller start-up businesses, eg becoming the dominant business in the market, international expansion, increasing shareholder value and ethical and environmental considerations • understand the success of a business can be measured in other ways than profit.